

The A to Z Reseller Operations Playbook

A practical guide to profitable listings, reliable fulfillment, and measured growth



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Includes 26 practical chapters, 26 worksheets, AI prompts, worked examples, a daily routine, and a 30-day implementation plan.

For independent online sellers who want a repeatable operating system. This guide teaches decision making and execution. It does not promise daily sales, a revenue milestone, or a marketplace ranking.

How to use this book

Start with chapters A, B, D, F, I, Q, and S. These establish the baseline, cash controls, daily routine, economics, inventory, quality, and shipping. Then use the remaining chapters to improve the bottleneck you can measure.

Each chapter has an operating lesson, five actions, an illustrative example, an AI prompt, and a worksheet. Complete one worksheet at a time and keep your actual marketplace records as the source of truth.

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Examples use hypothetical costs unless stated otherwise. Platform rules, interfaces, fees, carrier prices, and feature availability change. Verify live official guidance before implementing a policy. This guide is operational education rather than individual tax, legal, financial, or safety advice.

AI pictures are conceptual teaching illustrations. They are not photographs of listed products. Never use an illustration as proof of a product condition or feature.

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A Assess the business



Build a baseline before changing prices or buying inventory. Revenue shows activity; contribution profit shows whether orders pay for the work. A store can produce sales while losing cash through shipping, returns, advertising, and fixed subscriptions.

Put it into practice

1. Export active listings, orders, fees, traffic, and returns for the same date range. Record the date and market.
2. Separate item revenue, buyer shipping, marketplace-collected tax, fees, labels, refunds, and payouts. A payout is not profit.
3. Count distinct listing IDs separately from variation rows and available units.
4. Choose one constraint: poor visibility, weak clicks, weak conversion, low margin, or fulfillment capacity.
5. Set a 14-day experiment and record what will count as an improvement.

Worked example

A hypothetical store has 1,000 listings and 20 orders in 30 days. Orders divided by current listings is 2%, a rough velocity indicator. It is not cohort sell-through because inventory changed during the month.

A Worksheet and AI assistant

Use this AI prompt

Summarize this redacted store export. Separate facts, missing information, and hypotheses. Calculate rates only when numerator, denominator, and time window match. Do not invent costs.

Before using AI

Paste only the facts needed for this task. Remove private buyer and account details. Verify calculations, product claims, and policies yourself. AI drafts are not authorization to publish or spend money.

Complete your worksheet

Date range and source

Unique listings and available units

Orders and item revenue

Contribution profit and unknown costs

Primary constraint and next test

Decision and next action

What will I do next, by when, and what evidence will show whether it worked?
